AI SUCCESS PATTERNS - ROI WORKSHEET

Starter Pack Setup - $2,500

Your team's AI work, set up in a week - on your real work, in your tools.

74%
of companies see no measurable value from AI - and 70% of the problems are people and process, not technology. (BCG, 2024)

$186
per employee per month lost to AI "workslop" - low-quality AI output someone else has to fix. (BetterUp and Stanford, 2025)

80%+
of AI projects fail. The top cause: leaders never define the problem AI should solve. (RAND, 2024)

The investment

Starter Pack Setup, per team (small business: $750)	**$2,500**
Total	**$2,500**

The return - a worked example (replace with your numbers)

1. Rework avoided 8 people x $186/month x 6 months = $8,928 at stake. If the patterns cut it in half:	**$4,464**
2. Time saved 8 people x 1 hour/week x $75/hour x 26 weeks	**$15,600**
Total value	**$20,064**

$20,064
value over 6 months

8.0x
return on the investment

10 min
per person per week saved to break even

Value the math leaves out

- A shared language: "Did you run Avoid AI Slop?" replaces a long conversation
- Work that survives turnover - 42% of what people know lives only in their heads (Panopto, 2018)
- A one-page "how we use AI here" note your team keeps

Bring your numbers

- Pull your AI tool's usage report (Copilot, ChatGPT or Claude): how many paid seats are used weekly?
- Your loaded hourly cost and headcount in scope - the example uses $75/hour.

Illustrative example, not a guarantee - results depend on your team and how the patterns are used. Rework figure is BetterUp's published estimate; halving it is an assumption. Sources: BetterUp Labs and Stanford Social Media Lab, workslop survey, Sept 2025 (betterup.com); BCG, "Where's the Value in AI?", Oct 2024; RAND, Root Causes of Failure for AI Projects, Aug 2024; Gartner, HR leaders survey, Oct 28, 2025; Gartner Microsoft 365 and Copilot survey, May 2025 (as reported by techpartner.news); Panopto Workplace Knowledge and Productivity Report, 2018 (as reported by HR Dive).